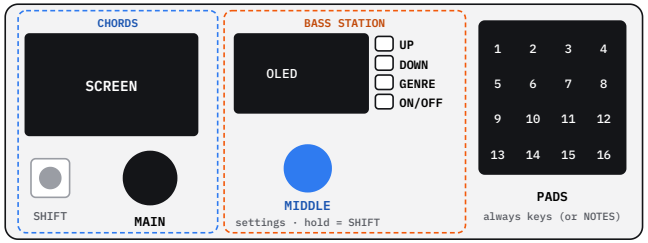
ChordBox. reference

THE PANEL: LEFT = CHORDS, MIDDLE = BASS



LEFT: MAIN KNOB (CHORDS)

turn	chord page (rolls through every bank)
click	the chord **MENU** on the screen: turn = move, click = open / done · past 16: **PERFORM**. The pads keep playing.
hold	closes the MENU · when closed: **MODES** (turn + click picks)
pad + turn	that chord's inversion
pad + click	**REPEAT** that chord on the clock until you let go
pad + middle turn	that chord's type: maj m 7 maj7 m7 9 m9 sus2 sus4 6 dim aug

A pad always plays its chord and brings the chord grid back: from the bass page, the MENU, MODES, SETUP. (Turning a MENU value: the pads play, the value stays open to hear it.) The first touch of MAIN or SHIFT also just brings the chords back.

MIDDLE: ONLY THE BASS

UP **DOWN**	the line before / after, heard straight away (with the Move running: from the next bar) · hold = fast
GENRE	tap: next genre, a line from it plays · hold: previous. 16 genres → **ANY** → FAVS
ON/OFF	tap: bass on / off · **hold: STAR** the line (→ FAVS)
knob turn	the setting on the OLED's bottom line
knob click	the next setting: OCTAVE −4…+2 · DENSITY · SWING · LENGTH · GATE · ACCENT · SLIDE · DUCK · FOLLOW · TEMPO
knob held = SHIFT	**PG UP** **PG DN** 16 lines · **RANDOM** a surprise · **NOTES** (below) · held + turn = genre

Browsing (UP DOWN GENRE PG RANDOM) shows the **bass page** on the left: the 16 lines around you, each as its feel, its strongest trait, an energy meter and its bar of notes. **ANY**: DOWN picks a random genre; UP replays what you heard.

NOTES: FIND THE KEY BY EAR

- Middle knob held + **NOTES**: the 16 pads play single notes on the bass channel, C upwards (pad 1 = C1). The bass line rests meanwhile.
- Play along with the Move. After a note: **FITS** (top button) or **CLASH** (second). Green = fits, red cross = clashes.
- The screens show the key they point to, e.g. **F minor 82%**. Three or four answers are usually enough.
- **USE KEY** (or middle click): **use that key** for chords and bass · middle turn = the pads' octave · **ON/OFF** = bass.
- Knob held + **LINES**: the pads play chords again; the bass line comes back.

READING THE SCREENS

- **Main screen**: the chords (or the NOTES grid). Top: mode · key · Move clock · tempo. Bottom: MAIN (turn · click) left, the middle knob right. While browsing bass: the bass page, until a pad or MAIN.
- **OLED**: genre (or ANY) · ON / MUTE / OFF · **what the line is**: its feel (ROLLING OFFBEAT ACID DOTTED SKIPPY GALLOP BOUNCY FUNKY DRIVING STEADY PUNCHY DEEP HELD SPARSE), traits (MELODIC ROOT OCTAVES SLIDES CHROMA LONG GHOSTS ACCENTS), energy 1–5 · its steps this bar · bottom: the knob's setting. NEXT = queued for the next bar.
- In NOTES: the last note, the key guess, the 12 notes marked.

MODES: MAIN HOLD, TURN, CLICK

1 **CHORD** the chord screen	2 **BASS** lines on the pads	3 **HUNT** chords of a sample	4 **LISTEN** chords from MIDI
5 **PLAY** a 16-slot loop	6 **GROW** 4 → 8 / 16 bars	7 **MELODY** a line on top	8 **TAKES** every version
9 **SETUP** all settings	10 **PHONE** QR, chordbox.local	11 **NEW SONG** forget the key	12 **BUTTONS** teach their order
13 **KEYPAD** teach the wiring	14 **PRINT** loop once → Move	15 **CAPTURE** bars played → loop	16 **A/B** previous version

A pad plays and closes it; MAIN hold again closes (or the buttons: 3rd = OPEN, the others CLOSE). In HUNT…MELODY the bottom button is MODES and a pad picks too. BUTTONS: press the four top to bottom when asked.

BASS MODE (MODES → 2): THE PADS ARE THE LINES

The bass page, and here the pads pick its lines (tap = play from the next bar; hold + MAIN click = STAR). MAIN turn = page, click = back to CHORD. In a cell: taller bar = higher note · red = accent · line along the top = held · **hollow = DENSITY skips it** · dots = bar of a 2/4-bar line. Its MENU (MAIN hold) has EDIT, the step editor.

CHORD MENU (MAIN CLICK, ON THE SCREEN)

ROOT key	**SCALE** off maj min dor…	**OCTAVE**	**BANK** mood bank
DICE substitutions	**VAR** back = same	**VOICING** close open shell st9	**STRUM** up / down
HUMAN late, loose	**LATCH** chords hold	**ALL OFF** stop all	**MORE** = SETUP
STAR keep row	**NEW** generate	**MUTATE** vary row	**FAVS** ↔ where you were

PERFORM (MENU 2/2 · HOLD SHIFT)

STRUM 0–400 ms	**HUMAN**	**SOFT** gentle ↔ hard	**B.OCT** bass octave
ARP up down up-down random chord	**RATE** 1/4…1/32, triplets	**RHYTHM** 8ths offbeat house 3-3-2 dub	**ECHO** 1/8 3/16 1/4
PLAY bass on/off	**REPEAT** its rate	**SWING**	**DENSITY**
LATCH	**REC** record → loop	**SCENE** tap load · hold save	**TEMPO** tap = tap tempo

SETUP (MODES → 9)

MAIN turn = select · middle turn = change · MAIN click = run / back · any pad = back.

CHORD: PHONE LINK · NEW SONG · VELOCITY · VOICELEAD · CHORD CH · GEN DARK · GEN TENS · GEN LEN · MUTATE N · VEL RAND · WEIGHT · STRUM DIR · ARP GATE · ARP OCT · RPT RAMP · ECHO FB · LOOP LEN · PLAIN · UNSTAR ROW

BASS: OCTAVE · LENGTH · BASS CH · NUDGE · FILL · PROG RATE · SWITCH · VELOCITY · RESYNC BAR

Both: SCENE · SAVE SCENE · UNDO · TEMP EDITS · CLOCK · MIDI IN CH · WIFI · MELODY CH · PANIC · SCREEN FLIP · KNOB DIR · KEYPAD SETUP · BUTTON SETUP

INTO THE MOVE

USB-C native	to the Move (MIDI + power). COM = the Mac.
channels	chords **1** · bass **2** · melody **3**
clock	the Move's MIDI clock leads (MOVE in the top bar); else INT tempo

SHIFT (KEY0) is optional: tap = bass on/off, hold = PERFORM; in HUNT…MELODY + a button = PRINT / A/B / CAPTURE / SETUP. Held at power-on: live-safe. Firmware: `./build.sh esp32 flash` or `ota`.

ChordBox. harmony engine

THE FIVE MODES

MODE	PADS	MAIN TURN · CLICK	MIDDLE KNOB	NO	YES
HUNT chords by ear	top row: shapes · 12 low notes C…B. **Orange = try this** ("5" = root + fifth)	octave (offers up: pick) · play loop	TUNE ±50 c · HOLD TEST · LENGTH	CLASH · NONE	FITS: this low note sits → 3 offers · KEEP
LISTEN from MIDI	chords, to play along	plain / twist · play	BASS IN (auto/ch) · BASS ONLY · LENGTH	CLEAR	USE IT: the heard chords → the loop
PLAY build the loop	THIN FULL WIDE FLIP · 12 one-finger chords (orange = outside)	shape (all 9) · play / stop	HOME · COLOUR · RHYTHM · TOP NOTE · LENGTH	CLEAR slot	ADD last chord to the next slot
GROW 8 / 16 bars	chords	Spice 0–7; ideas up: pick A B C · play	MOOD (heard as you turn) · LENGTH · RHYTHM · HOME · COLOUR	IDEAS / MORE / BACK	KEEP the one playing
MELODY a line on top	safe notes (green = in the chord now)	density 0–7 · play	VOICE · RANGE · NOTES (5 safe / 7) · LINE on/off	NEW line	TAP a rhythm over the next bar → a line
SLOTS top button / hold MAIN	16 slots: tap = select + hear · hold one, tap another = copy · SHIFT + slot = play from there	ranked next-chord suggestions for the slot · play	as the mode	CLEAR	LOCK (GROW won't touch it)
TAKES MODES → 8	–	browse · LOAD	–	BACK	STAR (kept for ever)

HUNT: THE CHORDS OF A SAMPLE

- MODES → 11 **NEW SONG**, then 3 HUNT. Middle knob on **TUNE**: hold a note, turn until the beating stops (old samples sit 20–50 cents off).
- Tap the **orange** pad, answer FITS / CLASH (no press = unsure). Root + fifth probes find the 7 notes in 3–4 answers.
- Per bar: find the lowest note that sits → YES → three chords containing it (on it, or it as 3rd / 5th: "D dark over F"). MAIN to hear each, YES keeps. The bar's slot fills; the next bar is next.
- The key fills in by itself (top bar + sure bars). When two are equally likely it asks one question: **"B OR Bb?"** (play it, answer) or **"DRONE D OR A: WHICH RESTS?"**.
- **HOLD TEST** (no clear bass): a tapped note drones; YES = never sounds wrong → bright or dark? → home or its fifth?

LISTEN: FROM INCOMING NOTES

Play the loop in a few times (a transcribed stem, a bassline, your own playing). It drops glitches and ghost overtones, keeps what repeats, finds the loop length (1/2/4/8 bars), the notes, home from the bass, and a chord per bar. **Bass only**: PLAIN (bass = root) or TWIST (bass = 3rd / 5th: F/A, Dm/F…). Without the Move's clock it finds the tempo itself (115–128 BPM).

THE CONTROLS IN THESE MODES

- The four buttons by the OLED, top to bottom: **SLOTS** (the pads ↔ the 16 slots) · **NO** · **YES** · **MODES**. The OLED names what NO and YES do right now (FITS, KEEP, ADD, TAP…).
- **MAIN**: turn = the mode's value (table) · click = play / stop the loop. **Middle knob**: turn = the setting shown bottom-right · click = the next one · **hold = tap "1"** (the bar starts here).

SPICE (GROW, MAIN TURN)

0	exactly what you entered (A A, literal)
1–2	shape only: thin A / full A', a flip at the end, a held top note, Early (chords a 16th ahead)
3–4	+ a way back at phrase ends (bVII, v7, bVI→bVII, V9sus), third swaps, split bars
5–6	+ one outside chord per 8 (IV, bIImaj7…), one shape over many basses, a stuck low note
7	+ slide shapes (parallel chords), one chromatic-third chord; may make A A B A

Slot 1, the A you entered and locked slots never change. No diminished chords, ≤2 outside chords in a row, outside chords always lead on smoothly.

MOODS (GROW, MIDDLE KNOB ON MOOD)

hypnotic deep · melancholic drive · euphoric, never lands · warm dorian funk · dusty 90s memory · piano house, hands up · gospel lift · sunset nostalgia · sunny, french disco · emotive anthem (16) · widescreen rise · lament, dramatic (16) · journey and return (A A B A, 16) · techno tension (low note stuck on home)

SOUND OF THE LOOP

SHAPE	**thin** (4 upper notes, no root: the bass has it) · full · wide (4ths) · flip (higher top) · shell · piano · piano 8va · colour (6/9, #11 on IV) · block
RHYTHM	sustain · offbeat · dotted · tresillo · deep · M1 piano · garage · pad push · techno · **out of the way** (only shared notes, a shell, the top: for samples that already carry harmony)
COLOUR	bright · bright mixo · dark · dark dorian
TOP NOTE	free · home's 5th · 3rd · 9th: the top voice stays near it, every chord voice-led
HOME	by hand (the chords move with it); after HUNT / LISTEN it follows what was found

MELODY

- Pads: the 5-note scale over 2+ octaves (NOTES = all 7). Nothing can clash.
- **YES (TAP)**: tap a rhythm on any pad over the next bar; it picks the notes. **NO**: a whole new line.
- Voices: **lead hook** (2–4 notes, repeats) · **flute** (long, stepwise, grace notes) · **house piano** (octaves, call & response) · **arp** (the chord's notes in order).
- Form A A' A B: on-beat notes are chord notes; it ends on root, 3rd or 5th.

TAKES, CAPTURE, PRINT

- **Every change is a take** (32 kept, starred never age out, saved through power-off). **Hold NO** = step back one take every 0.6 s.
- **MODES → 16 A/B**: the previous take, on the next bar line (again = back) · **MODES → 15 CAPTURE**: the last bars you played on the pads become the loop.
- **Print to the Move**: arm a clip recording, **MODES → 14 PRINT**: the loop plays once from the next bar line (or from the Move's start), then stops.
- **NEW SONG** forgets the key and the votes (the old loop stays in TAKES). The song profile saves itself; there is no save button.

FIVE MINUTES: A LOOP

MODES → 5 PLAY · middle knob: HOME, click, COLOUR · chord pad + YES ×4 · MAIN click to play · MODES → 6 GROW · NO for ideas, MAIN picks, YES keeps · arm the Move · MODES → 14 PRINT.